THE PIS GUIDE

Go Electric.

Everything you need to know about switching to an EV - written by our NICEIC-approved engineers, no jargon, no marketing spin.

✓ 20 min read ✓ UK-specific ✓ Updated 2026

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Why go electric

Roughly one in three new cars sold in the UK in 2026 is electric. The reasons are practical: a smart-charged EV costs about a third of what a comparable petrol car costs to run, maintenance is lower because there's no engine oil, no spark plugs and no clutch, and the driving experience - quiet, instant torque, smooth - genuinely is better than the equivalent ICE.

The five honest reasons people switch

- **Running cost.** On an EV-friendly tariff like Octopus Intelligent, charging overnight at home works out at around 7p per kWh - roughly £2-3 to add 100 miles of range.
- **Predictable costs.** No fuel-price shocks. You're locked into your home tariff.
- **Less servicing.** Brakes last longer (regenerative braking), no oil changes, no exhaust system.
- **Company-car tax.** Benefit-in-kind on EVs is around 3% in 2026 - vs 25%+ on petrol cars.
- **Quiet, smooth, fast.** Once you've driven an EV daily, going back to an ICE feels noisy and slow.

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Choosing your first EV

Most first-time EV buyers obsess over range. In reality, range matters far less than you'd expect once you have a home charger - because you start every day with a full battery.

Range, in plain English

The WLTP figure (the one quoted on every spec sheet) is a standardised test result. Real-world range tends to be 75-85% of the WLTP number in summer, and 65-75% in cold UK winters.

For most UK drivers, a real-world range of 200 miles covers a full week of commuting plus a school run. For motorway-heavy lifestyles, look for 300+ miles WLTP.

BEV or PHEV?

A **battery electric vehicle (BEV)** runs only on electricity. A **plug-in hybrid (PHEV)** has both a small battery (typically 30-50 mile electric range) and a petrol engine. PHEVs work for high-mileage drivers who can't always charge, but if you can charge at home, a BEV is cheaper to run, simpler, and qualifies for better company-car tax.

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Charging at home

A 7.4 kW home charger adds roughly 25-30 miles of range per hour. Plugged in at 6pm, gone by 7am the next morning, fully charged - and at off-peak rates. Home charging is what makes EVs cheap.

Tethered vs untethered

Tethered chargers come with a permanently attached cable. Convenient - you just plug in. **Untethered** units have a Type 2 socket and you bring your own cable. Slightly tidier when not charging, slightly more faff at every plug-in.

Smart features that actually matter

- **Tariff scheduling** - charges automatically during cheap off-peak windows (essential).
- **App control** - check status, change schedules, set monthly budgets.
- **OCPP 1.6** - open protocol that works with multiple back-end providers; useful if you want to switch tariffs later.
- **Solar / PV diversion** - charges from your solar surplus before the battery dumps to the grid (only relevant if you have solar).
- **Dynamic load balancing** - prevents tripping your main fuse when the kettle, oven and EV charge at the same time.

The Ohme range, in 30 seconds

The **Ohme Home Pro** is the UK's best-selling smart charger - tariff-aware, tethered, with a clear LED display. The **Ohme ePod** is the same brains in a smaller, untethered body. The **Easee One** is a slim modular unit that's 3-phase ready if you have the supply for it.

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Costs & savings

Install cost

A standard install with up to 10 metres of cabling, an integrated isolator and certification typically lands between £950 and £1,400 fully fitted. Where the run is longer, the consumer unit needs an upgrade, or the supply needs balancing, you'll be quoted more - but a fixed-price quote up front means no surprises on the day.

Running cost

For 7,000 miles a year in a typical 60 kWh BEV with 240 mile real-world range:

- Average UK tariff (~27p/kWh): about £475/year
- Octopus Intelligent off-peak (~7p/kWh, ~85% of charging): about £150/year
- Petrol equivalent (45 MPG, 145p/litre): about £1,020/year

A typical home-charging EV driver saves £700-£900 per year on fuel alone, before you count servicing.

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Public charging

For long journeys, the UK now has more than 75,000 public charging connectors. Rapid (50-150 kW) and ultra-rapid (150-350 kW) chargers along motorways will add 100-200 miles in 20-30 minutes.

Apps you'll actually use

- **Zapmap** - the de facto map of every public charger in the UK with live status.
- **Octopus Electroverse** - one card, one app, works across most networks; simpler than juggling 5 different apps.
- **Tesla / Ionity / Gridserve / BP Pulse** - the network-specific apps if you charge regularly at one chain.

06

Grants, finance & tax

OZEV grant (up to £350)

If you rent, own a flat or run a business, the OZEV grant covers up to £350 of your install cost. Owner-occupier homeowners no longer qualify (the residential grant ended in 2022). We handle the paperwork on your behalf and the grant comes off the invoice.

0% finance via Bumper

Spread the install cost over 12-36 months with no interest. Soft credit check, takes a few minutes online, no deposit required.

Salary sacrifice

If your employer offers an EV salary-sacrifice scheme, you can lease an EV (and often the install) out of your gross salary - which can mean 30-50% off the headline cost. Worth asking your HR team.

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Going-electric checklist

1. **Pick your car.** Aim for at least 200 miles real-world range for most UK lifestyles. Confirm WLTP, max AC kW (7.4 or 11), and connector (Type 2 + CCS for almost all modern EVs).
2. **Check your parking.** OZEV grant requires off-street parking. If you don't have it, you can still install a charger on private land or look at on-street solutions.
3. **Get a home-charger quote.** Fixed price, includes survey, install, certification and any consumer-unit upgrade. We respond in 24 hours.
4. **Switch to an EV-friendly tariff.** Octopus Intelligent / Octopus Go / EDF GoElectric. We can set this up at install.
5. **Install day.** Most installs are 3-5 hours. We commission the charger, walk you through the app, and clean up.
6. **Drive.** Plug in nightly. Your monthly fuel spend drops the next day.

Ready when you are.

When you're ready for a charger, we'll have a fixed-price quote in your inbox within 24 hours.

Get my free quote

Try the cost calculator